CampusSwap — Project Guide & Tracker

What we are building for the UX/UI for Startups retake, what every term means, what is done, and what is left.

Student: Ahmed Helaly **Course:** UX/UI for Startups (retake, max grade B) **Updated:** 2 Nov 2026

1. What the course asks for

The retake is graded on four project assignments plus a live exam. The course page lists all four, even though the instructor's email mentions three. Prepare all of them.

#	Assignment	What it proves	Main pieces
1	**UX Research**	You can learn what users really need	Research plan, interview guide, survey, research report, rough design
2	**Lo-Fi Prototype** (midterm)	You can turn research into features and a first rough design	Interview notes, themes, feature ideas, prioritization, user flow, paper sketches, 4 grey screens
3	**Hi-Fi Prototype**	You can test a design and turn it into a polished, clickable app	Usability test, user flow v2.0, moodboard, style guide, pattern library, final screens + prototype link
4	**Case Study** (final exam)	You can tell the whole story clearly	A presentation (Google Slides) + live demo of the Figma prototype

Exam format: 20–30 min presentation and prototype demo, then 5–10 min where the instructor inspects the Figma file and asks questions. Camera and screen share on, school ID ready. Expect at least 2 theory questions on the course material and how it applies to your project. Everything must be in **one Figma file**, plus an offline `.fig` copy.

2. Our project in one paragraph

CampusSwap is a mobile app for students living in the university dorms. Students who are moving out list items they no longer need (lamps, kettles, books). Students who need those items find them nearby, request them, and agree on a pickup time and place inside the app. Only verified students can join, which builds trust. The problem we are solving: usable items get thrown away while newcomers buy the same things new, because Telegram chats and Avito make this slow and awkward.

3. The process, step by step

A UX project moves from **understanding people** to **designing** to **testing** to **polishing**. Each step uses what the previous step found.

1
Research
Talk to real students (interviews) and ask many students (survey). Look at what already exists.

2
Synthesis
Group what you heard into themes, turn them into feature ideas, pick the most valuable ones.

3
Lo-fi
Sketch on paper, then build rough grey screens to check the flow makes sense.

4
Test
Watch 2–5 students try the prototype. Note where they get stuck. Fix the flow.

5
Hi-fi
Add colors, fonts, icons and real content. Make it clickable like a real app.

6
Case study
Tell the story: problem → research → design → results → what you learned.

4. Glossary: the terms you will hear

Research words

Term	Plain meaning	In our project
UX / UI	UX (user experience) = how easy and pleasant the whole product is to use. UI (user interface) = what the screens look like.	UX: the flow from finding to picking up an item. UI: colors, buttons, cards.
Research plan	A document that says what you want to learn, from whom, and how.	`01-research-plan.pdf` and Figma frame A.1
Research goals / questions	Goals = the big things you want to understand. Questions = the specific things you need answered.	3 goals, 7 questions
Semi-structured interview	A conversation with a prepared list of questions, but you follow up on interesting answers.	5–6 dorm residents, 25 min, 14 questions
Interview guide / script	The exact intro, questions and closing you read during an interview.	Figma frame A.2
Rationale	The reason you ask a question. The rubric wants one next to every question.	Right column in the interview and survey tables
Survey	A short online form many people fill in. Gives numbers ("62% said…").	13 questions, Google Forms, target 30+ answers
Likert scale	A 1–5 rating answer, from "strongly disagree" to "strongly agree".	Survey questions 7 and 12
Recruiting criteria / screener	Rules for who can join your study, and the short questions that check it.	Must live in the dorms; mix of givers and getters
Competitive analysis	Comparing products people already use, to find what's missing.	Telegram chats, Avito, VK, free shelf vs CampusSwap

Research report	A summary of what you learned: executive summary, key findings with quotes, recommendations.	Figma frame B (to fill after interviews)
Executive summary	3–4 sentences someone busy can read instead of the whole report.	Top of the report
Key finding	One important thing you learned, backed by data (quotes, counts).	At least 2 needed
Persona	A realistic description of a typical user, based on research.	"A newcomer who needs a desk lamp" in the user flow

Synthesis words

Term	Plain meaning	In our project
Synthesis	Turning raw notes into clear insights.	Lo-Fi section A.1–A.4
Sticky notes / interview notes	One idea per note, one color per participant, so you can see who said what.	Figma frame A.1 (6 colored columns)
Affinity map	Moving sticky notes into groups of similar ideas. Each group becomes a theme.	Figma frame A.2
Theme	A pattern many people mentioned, e.g. "trust and safety".	4 draft themes
How Might We (HMW)	Turning a problem into an opportunity question: "How might we make pickup effortless?"	One HMW per theme
Feature ideation	Brainstorming many possible features (quantity first).	15 feature ideas, frame A.3
Feature prioritization	Choosing which features to build first, usually by value vs effort.	Value vs complexity matrix, frame A.4
Value vs complexity matrix	A 2×2 chart. Top-left (high value, simple) = build first ("quick wins").	7 features selected for the MVP
MVP	Minimum viable product: the smallest version that solves the main problem.	Sign-up, post, search, filter, free/sell, chat, pickup
Value proposition	One statement of who it's for, what it does, and why it's better than alternatives.	Hi-Fi frame A.1

Design words

Term	Plain meaning	In our project
User flow	The steps a user takes to finish a goal, from start to end.	7 steps: onboard → discover → evaluate → request → pickup → handover → rate
Journey map	A user flow with stages and tasks (and sometimes feelings) laid out left to right.	Lo-Fi frame B.1
Crazy 8s	Fold a paper into 8 boxes and sketch 8 screen ideas in 8 minutes. Speed over beauty.	Lo-Fi frame B.2 (you draw them)

Wireframe	A screen drawn with grey boxes and plain text only, to plan layout. No colors.	The 4 grey screens
Lo-fi (low fidelity)	Rough and simple: sketches or grey wireframes. Cheap to change. Used to test the flow.	Lo-Fi section (midterm)
Hi-fi (high fidelity)	Looks like the real app: final colors, fonts, icons, content.	Hi-Fi section B.4
Mockup	A static picture of a hi-fi screen.	Each hi-fi screen
Prototype	Screens linked together so you can click through them like a real app. Can be lo-fi or hi-fi.	Figma Present mode → "Lo-Fi prototype" / "Hi-Fi prototype"
Clickable prototype / prototype link	A Figma link (figma.com/proto/…) anyone can open to try the prototype.	Needed in the Hi-Fi frame and on the deck with a QR code
Moodboard	A collage of inspiration (apps, colors, fonts) that sets the feeling of the design.	Hi-Fi frame B.1
Style guide	The visual rules: colors, fonts and sizes, icons, corner radius, shadows.	Hi-Fi frame B.2
Pattern library / UI kit	All reusable building blocks: buttons, inputs, cards, navigation.	Hi-Fi frame B.3
Design system	Style guide + pattern library + rules, used together.	B.2 + B.3
Atomic design	Building UI from small to big: atoms (colors, icons) → molecules (button) → organisms (card) → pages.	How B.3 is organized
Design principles	Rules of good UI, e.g. visual hierarchy (important = bigger), Fitts's law (big, close buttons are easier to tap), Hick's law (fewer choices = faster decisions), consistency.	Rough design frame C explains which ones we used
Contrast / WCAG	WCAG = accessibility guidelines. Text needs enough contrast with its background (4.5:1 for normal text).	White on our green = 5.2:1 (passes)

Testing words

Term	Plain meaning	In our project
Usability testing	Watching real people try your prototype to see where they struggle.	2–5 sessions with 4 tasks
Moderated / unmoderated	Moderated: you are there guiding. Unmoderated: they do it alone (e.g. Maze).	Moderated
Usability study guide	The plan + script for the test: who, setup, intro, warm-up questions, tasks, wrap-up.	Hi-Fi frame A.2
Opening ethnography	A few warm-up questions about the person's real life before the tasks.	3 questions
Task / success criteria	Something you ask them to do, and what counts as "done".	T1–T4
Think-aloud	Participants say what they're thinking while using the prototype.	Asked in the intro script

SEQ	Single Ease Question: "How easy was that, 1–7?" after each task.	After each task
Iteration / v2.0	Improving the design based on test results.	User flow v2.0, Hi-Fi frame A.3

Figma words

Term	Plain meaning
Frame	A container, like an artboard. Each screen and each document block is a frame.
Section	A big labeled area grouping frames. Our file has 5: Cover, UX Research, Lo-Fi, Hi-Fi, Case Study.
Component / instance / variant	A component is a reusable master element (e.g. Button). Instances are copies that update when the master changes. Variants are versions of one component (Primary / Secondary).
Auto layout	Figma's way of stacking items with automatic spacing, like CSS flexbox.
Variables / styles	Saved colors and text styles reused across the file.
Present mode / flow	The ▶ button plays the prototype. A flow is a named starting screen.
.fig file	Offline copy of the Figma file (File → Save local copy). Required for submission.

5. What has been made so far

Deliverable	Where	Status
Figma file with all sections	figma.com/design/FBkfowqM4rI8lcgZ8fuzQv	**Mostly built**
Research plan (PDF)	`01-research-plan.pdf`	**Done**
Case study deck (draft)	`CampusSwap-Case-Study.pptx` → upload to Google Drive to get Google Slides	**Draft** with marked gaps
Exam prep checklist	`ux-ui-retake-prep.md`	**Done**
This guide	`00-project-guide.pdf`	**Done**
Repository + documentation site	github.com/escalopa/campusswap · escalopa.github.io/campusswap	**Done**
Telegram bot (Python, runs locally)	Repository folder `bot/`	**MVP done**

Inside the Figma file

Section	Frames	Status
00 Cover	Title slide	**Done**
01 UX Research	A.1 Research plan · A.2 Interview guide · A.3 Survey · B Research report · B Competitive analysis · C Rough design	**Built** report and research link need your data
02 Lo-Fi	A.1 Interview notes · A.2 Themes · A.3 15 ideas · A.4 Prioritization · B.1 User flow · B.2 Crazy 8s · B.3 4 clickable grey screens + wireframe kit	**Built** notes, themes and sketches need your data
03 Hi-Fi	A.1 Idea brief · A.2 Usability study guide · A.3 User flow v2.0 · B.1 Moodboard · B.2 Style guide · B.3 Pattern library · B.4 Screens 1–7 + clickable prototype	**Done**
04 Case Study	Deck links, prototype QR code, slide outline	**Done**

Figma: all design work that doesn't need research data is done. Dashed coral boxes in the file mark places that need real interview or test data; nothing there is invented. Prototype: figma.com/proto/FBkfowqM4rI8lcgZ8fuzQv (flow "Hi-Fi prototype").

6. Tracker: what's left and who does it

You needs you in person · **Claude** I can do it · **Blocked** waiting on something

#	Task	Who	Depends on	Done
Research (assignment 1)				
1	Create 2 Google Forms: screener + survey (questions are ready in the plan)	**You**	—	☐

2	Post the recruiting message in dorm and course chats	You	1	☐
3	Run 5–6 interviews with the guide; record or take notes	You	2	☐
4	Collect 30+ survey responses; export results	You	1	☐
5	Send me the notes / transcripts and survey export	You	3, 4	☐
6	Fill interview notes, themes, HMW, report, key findings; confirm MVP features	Claude	5 + Figma limit	☐
7	Draw a hand sketch of one screen; photograph it	You	—	☐
Lo-Fi (assignment 2)				
8	Draw Crazy 8s (8 sketches, 8 minutes), photograph and send	You	—	☐
9	Paste sketches into Figma; adjust lo-fi screens to findings	Claude	6, 8 + Figma limit	☐
Hi-Fi (assignment 3)				
10	Finish hi-fi screens 5–7, wire the hi-fi prototype, check screens 1–4	Claude	—	☑
11	Run 2–5 usability tests with the study guide (on the prototype)	You	9 or 10	☐
12	Update user flow v2.0 and screens with test results	Claude	11 + Figma limit	☐
13	Paste moodboard screenshots (Vinted, Too Good To Go, etc.)	You or Claude	—	☐
Case study (assignment 4) and submission				
14	Upload the .pptx to Google Drive and open as Google Slides	You	—	☐
15	Check the deck's rendering in Google Slides and fix layout	Claude	14	☐
16	Fill findings, test results, key learnings, About me, timeline in the deck	Both	6, 11	☐
17	Add hi-fi screenshots, prototype link and QR code to the deck	Claude	10	☑
18	Link the deck in the Figma file (section 04) so everything is in one file	Claude	—	☑
19	Set sharing to "Anyone with the link can view" (Figma + Slides); save .fig copy; export deck as PDF	You	all	☐
20	Rehearse: 25-min run-through + live prototype demo; review theory topics	You	all	☐

7. Optional: build a working version of the app

The course grades the **research, the Figma design and the presentation**. A working app is not required and won't raise the maximum retake grade (B). Its real value is evidence: if real students use it for a week, you can show real numbers in the case study ("14 students posted 31 items"). Estimates below assume I write the code and you handle accounts, keys and testing with students.

Option	What you get	Effort	You need
A. Telegram bot Go or Python, Postgres, Cloud Run	Post an item (photo, category, Free/price, building), browse by category/building, request, pick a pickup slot, confirm handover, rate. Students use it inside Telegram, where they already are.	**~2–4 days** MVP 2 days, deploy + fixes 1–2	Bot token from @BotFather; Google Cloud project with billing (free tier covers it)
B. Mobile web app (PWA) Next.js + Supabase, on Vercel or Cloud Run	The hi-fi design as a website that opens on any phone and can be added to the home screen. Email sign-up, photos, listings, chat-style requests, pickup slots.	**~5–8 days**	Supabase/Vercel or Google Cloud account; domain optional
C. Native mobile app + backend Expo (React Native), Go API on Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, Cloud Storage, push	A real iOS/Android app matching the Figma screens, with backend, image upload, notifications and university-email verification.	**~3–4 weeks** (12–18 working days)	Google Cloud billing (~$10–30/month for Cloud SQL), Apple developer account ($99/year) for iPhone testers

Decision: option A, the Telegram bot, in Python. It runs locally with a config file (no hosting for now). The MVP is built and tested: onboarding, posting, browsing, requests with pickup slots, accept/decline, handover and ratings. Code and setup guide: github.com/escalopa/campusswap (folder `bot/`). Next: create a bot token with @BotFather and test it with 3–5 students.

8. Exam day checklist

Before

- Figma file shared as "Anyone with the link can view"; `.fig` saved
- Google Slides deck shared; PDF export ready
- Prototype opens and the whole flow works
- School ID on the desk; camera and mic tested

Theory to review

- Design thinking / double diamond; Lean UX
- Interviews vs surveys; qualitative vs quantitative; bias
- Affinity mapping, HMW, prioritization; design sprint
- Hierarchy, Gestalt, Fitts / Hick / Jakob, WCAG contrast
- Lo-fi vs hi-fi; components, variants, auto layout
- Usability testing: why 5 users, moderated vs unmoderated
- Handoff and atomic design